🏊 STUDENT BRIEFING · SWIMMING CARNIVAL

Swimming Carnival Student Briefing

Everything you need to know before you get in the water — rules, safety, emergency procedures, and what to bring. Read this before carnival day.

Year 7–10 HPE | Victorian Curriculum 2.0 | VC2HP8P08 · VC2HP8P09 · VC2HP8M01

CARNIVAL DATE & VENUE	YOUR TEACHER	YOUR CLASS

000

If someone is in danger — call 000 immediately. Say your location, your school name, and what has happened. Stay on the line.

📋 The Rules — Everyone Must Know These

1

Stay in your lane

Never cross into another lane during a race or warm-up. Stay where you're assigned.

2

Feet first — always

No diving unless specifically instructed. Enter the pool feet first at all times except designated dive starts.

3

No running

Walk on all pool surrounds at all times. Wet pool decks cause serious falls.

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4

No pushing

Never push anyone into the pool. No horseplay near the water's edge. This is a safety rule — not a suggestion.

5

Swim when told

Only enter the water when directed by a teacher, official, or lifeguard. Not before.

6

Stay visible

Do not leave the pool area without telling your teacher. You must be accounted for at all times.



If you need help in the water — raise ONE arm

Raise one arm straight up and hold it there. Do not wave both arms. One arm held up is the recognised distress signal — lifeguards and teachers will see it immediately. Keep your head up and stay as calm as you can.

🎒 What to Bring

- [ ] Towel and change of clothes
- [ ] Goggles (recommended)
- [ ] Swimwear (appropriate to school policy)
- [ ] Water bottle (stay hydrated — even at a pool)
- [ ] Sunscreen (if outdoor venue)
- [ ] Hat and t-shirt (for when you're not swimming)
- [ ] Snack / lunch (check if food is available on site)
- [ ] Completed permission form (if applicable)
- [ ] Medical information form (if you have a medical condition)
- [ ] Any prescribed medication (notify your teacher)

📍 Know These Locations on Arrival

FIRST AID STATION

_____

TOILETS / CHANGE ROOMS

_____

YOUR CLASS ASSEMBLY POINT

_____

DRINKING WATER

_____

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DEFIBRILLATOR (AED) LOCATION

EMERGENCY EXIT

⚠️ When you arrive

Before anything else — locate the first aid station and the AED. You might never need them. But if you do, you won't have time to find them. 30 seconds of looking around when you arrive could save someone's life.

🩺 Medical Conditions & Medications

If you have a medical condition — your teacher must know

- If you have asthma, epilepsy, a heart condition, or any condition that affects your ability to swim safely — notify your teacher before the carnival. Not on the day. Before.
- Bring any prescribed medications (asthma inhaler, EpiPen) and hand them to the first aid officer on arrival.
- If you feel unwell at any point during the carnival — tell a teacher or the first aid officer immediately. Do not get into the water.
- Never swim if you feel dizzy, unwell, or unusually tired.

🚨 If You See Someone in Trouble

Do not jump in after them

Even if you are a confident swimmer — a panicking person in the water can pull you under. Untrained water rescuers become victims. The instinct to dive in is natural. Resist it.

✅ DO THIS	❌ DON'T DO THIS
📢 **Call for help loudly** — shout "LIFEGUARD!" or "HELP!" and point at the person.	⛔ **Jump in** if you are not trained in water rescue.
📞 **Call 000** — or direct someone specific: "You — call 000 now."	⛔ **Assume someone else will act** — name someone specifically and give them a specific instruction.
🪢 **Throw something** — rope, kickboard, pool noodle, towel, anything that floats.	⛔ **Freeze** — the first seconds matter. Act immediately.

🗣️ **Talk to them** — keep them calm and focused on you from the edge.

⛔ **Lean out to grab them** by hand — you risk being pulled in yourself.

🩺 DRS ABCD — If Someone Is Unresponsive

D	R	S	A	B	C	D
DANGER	**RESPONSE**	**SEND 000**	**AIRWAY**	**BREATHING**	**CPR**	**DEFIB**
Is it safe for you?	Tap & call their name	Call for help NOW	Tilt head back gently	Look, listen, feel	30 pushes + 2 breaths	AED if available

CPR reminder: 30 chest compressions followed by 2 rescue breaths. Push hard — 5–6cm deep — at 100–120 beats per minute (the tempo of *Stayin' Alive*). Do not stop until emergency services arrive or the person recovers.

Secondary drowning: Anyone who was submerged — even briefly, even if they seem fine — must be assessed by the first aid officer. Symptoms can appear hours later. This is non-negotiable.

🤝 Behaviour & Sportsmanship

What a swimming carnival looks like at its best

- Cheer for your house and your school — including competitors from other teams.
- Respect the officials' decisions without argument.
- Support classmates who are nervous or less confident swimmers — a carnival is for everyone.
- Look after each other near the water. If you see a friend who looks unwell or distressed — tell a teacher.
- Represent your school with the character you'd want someone to remember.

Behaviour that will result in removal from the carnival

- Running on pool surrounds
- Pushing or shoving anyone near the water
- Entering the water without permission
- Deliberately interfering with another swimmer's race
- Leaving the venue without permission
- Bullying or intimidating behaviour of any kind

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✍️ Student Acknowledgement

I have read this briefing. I understand the safety rules, the emergency procedures, and what is expected of me at the swimming carnival. I know to call 000 in an emergency and to alert a teacher or first aid officer if I see someone in difficulty.

STUDENT NAME	CLASS	SIGNATURE & DATE

Swim & Water Safety — Swimming Carnival Student Briefing · Year 7–10 HPE · Victorian Curriculum F–10 Version 2.0

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